

Word family: **join / joins / joined / joining / joint**

Base word: join

Past tense: joined

Past participle: joined

-ing form: joining

Related form: joint

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun-adjective related form (相關名詞 / 形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “For a few years, we were almost **joined at the hip**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **joined at the hip** is a fixed expression meaning **two people spend so much time together and are so close that they seem almost inseparable**.

繁體中文： **兩個人關係非常親密，經常在一起，幾乎形影不離**

中文翻譯：

> “For a few years, we were almost **joined at the hip**.”

「有好幾年的時間，我們幾乎可以說是**形影不離 / 總是黏在一起**。」

Here:

joined at the hip = 關係非常親密，幾乎總是在一起

1. **join + group/organization/team (團體 / 組織) — 加入；成為成員**

Meaning: To become a member of a group, organization, team, club, company, etc.

Practice 1

> “She **joined** the school club last year.”

「她去年**加入了**學校的社團。」

Practice 2

> “He plans to **join** the company after graduation.”

「他打算畢業後**加入**這家公司。」

****join a group/organization = 成為某個團體、組織或機構的一員****

Common:

- * join a club
- * join a team
- * join a company
- * join the army
- * join an organization

These belong to one membership sense.

2. ****join + person/activity (一起參與) — 加入 ; 一起做****

****Meaning:**** To become involved in an activity with other people, or go and be with someone.

Practice 3

> “Would you like to ****join us**** for lunch?”

「你想不想****加入我們一起吃午飯****？」

Practice 4

> “She ****joined**** the discussion halfway through.”

「她中途****加入了討論****。」

****join someone / join an activity = 與別人會合並一起參與某項活動****

This is different from formally becoming a member of an organization.

3. ****join = connect two or more things (物件 / 部分) — 連接 ; 接合****

****Meaning:**** To connect two or more separate things so that they form one whole or continuous structure.

Practice 5

> “The bridge ****joins**** the two sides of the river.”

「這座橋把河的兩岸**連接起來**。」

Practice 6

> “The two pieces are **joined** together with glue.”

「兩件物件用膠水**黏合 / 接合**在一起。」

****join things = 把原本分開的物件、部分或位置連接成一體****

This is a genuinely different physical meaning.

4. ****roads/rivers/lines join (匯合 / 相接) — 交會 ; 匯合****

****Join**** can be intransitive when two paths, rivers, lines, etc. meet.

Practice 7

> “The two roads **join** near the station.”

「兩條道路在車站附近**交會 / 連接**。」

Practice 8

> “The smaller river **joins** the main river further north.”

「較小的河流在更北面**匯入 / 匯合**主河道。」

****two things join = 兩條路線、河流、線條等在某一點相接或匯合****

For database counting, I would merge this with Meaning 3 under the broader concept:

> ****become connected****

5. ****join hands/forces (人 / 團體合作) — 聯手 ; 合作****

A figurative extension means people or groups combine their efforts.

Practice 9

> “The two organizations ****joined forces**** to support the project.”

「兩個機構**聯手合作**支持這個項目。」

Practice 10

> “The community **joined hands** to help the family.”

「社區居民**攜手合作**幫助這個家庭。」

****join forces/hands = 把各自的力量、資源或努力結合起來共同做某件事****

This is best treated as a fixed-expression extension of the ****combine/connect**** sense.

Target expression: ****joined at the hip — 形影不離****

This is the expression used in your passage.

Practice 11 — Original

> “For a few years, we were almost ****joined at the hip****.”

「有好幾年的時間，我們幾乎****形影不離****。」

Practice 12

> “Those two have been ****joined at the hip**** since university.”

「那兩個人從大學開始就一直****形影不離****。」

****joined at the hip = 兩個人關係非常親密，幾乎總是在一起****

This is idiomatic and should not be counted as a separate core meaning of bare ****join****.

Related form: ****joint****

****Joint**** has several useful meanings of its own, but the directly related one here is:

**joint = shared / done together (共同的) — 聯合的 ; 共同的**

Practice 13

> “They made a ****joint**** decision.”

「他們作出了一個**共同決定**。」

Practice 14

> “The two schools organized a **joint** event.”

「兩間學校舉辦了一個**聯合活動**。」

****joint** = 由兩個或以上的人 / 機構共同擁有、安排或進行的

However, ****joint**** also has other meanings, such as a body joint or connection point, so it could justify its own separate polysemy entry if needed.

Important distinction: ****join** vs **attend**

****join****

means become involved with or participate together with others.

****attend****

means be present at an event, class, meeting, etc.

> “I joined the club.”

= 我成為了社團成員。

> “I attended the meeting.”

= 我出席了會議。

You can attend something without becoming a member of it.

Important distinction: ****join** vs **enter**

****join****

often involves becoming part of a group or activity.

****enter****

often means go into a place, competition, system, etc.

> “She joined the team.”

= 她成為隊伍一員。

> “She entered the competition.”

= 她參加了比賽。

Not always interchangeable.

Important distinction: **join** vs **connect**

join

can mean physically make two things become one continuous structure.

connect

is broader and can refer to physical, technical, logical, or communicative links.

> “Join the two pieces.”

= 把兩件東西接合。

> “Connect the computer to the network.”

= 把電腦連接到網絡。

Important distinction: **join** vs **combine**

join

often emphasizes separate things meeting or connecting.

combine

emphasizes mixing or bringing elements together to form a whole.

> “The two roads join.”

> “Combine the ingredients.”

Different typical uses.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **join**
* **joined**
* **joining**
* **joint**

Useful expressions include:

* join a club
* join someone
* join a discussion
* join two pieces
* join forces
* join hands
* joined at the hip

The Golden Manual says fixed expressions and related forms should be included when useful, but they should not be miscounted as new core meanings if they grow from the same underlying semantic idea.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
join — become a member	成為某個團體、組織、機構或隊伍的一員
join — participate/be with others	與別人會合並一起參與某項活動、談話或行程
join — connect things	把原本分開的物件、部分、線路或位置連接成一體
things join — meet/connect	兩條道路、河流、線條等在某一點相接或匯合；屬於 connect 義
join forces/hands	把力量、資源或努力結合起來共同做某件事
joint — shared	由兩個或以上的人 / 機構共同進行、擁有或安排的
joined at the hip	兩個人關係非常親密，幾乎總是在一起；形影不離

For your original sentence

> “For a few years, we were almost **joined at the hip**.”

The exact meaning is:

****joined at the hip = 兩個人非常親密，經常一起行動，幾乎形影不離****

So:

> ****we were almost joined at the hip****

= ****我們幾乎總是黏在一起 / 形影不離****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely distinct core meanings**** for ****join****:

1. ****become a member of a group/organization****
2. ****join someone/activity — participate or be together****
3. ****connect/combine separate things****

I would merge ****roads/rivers join**** into #3, and treat ****join forces, join hands, joined at the hip**** as fixed or figurative extensions rather than inflate the core count.